

Developing a Simple Web Application Using Flutter



This article guides readers on how to run and deploy their first Web application using Flutter.

Flutter has moved to a new stage, the Web, after having travelled a long way in Android and iOS development. Flutter 1.5 has been released by Google, along with support for Web application development.

Configuring Flutter for the Web

In order to use the Web package, enter the `flutter upgrade` command to update to Flutter version 1.5.4.

- Open a terminal
- Type `flutter upgrade`
- Check the version by typing `flutter --version`

One can also use Android Studio 3.0 or later versions for Flutter Web development, but we will use Visual Studio Code for this tutorial.

Creating a new project with Flutter Web

Open Visual Studio Code and press `Shift+Ctrl+P` to start a new project. Type `flutter` and select `New Web Project`.

Now, name the project. I have named it `open_source_for_you`.

Open the terminal window in VSC, and type in the following commands:

```
flutter packages pub global activate webdev
```

```
flutter packages upgrade
```

```
[jis:~ jisjoe$ flutter upgrade
Upgrading Flutter from /Users/jisjoe/Downloads/flutter...
From https://github.com/flutter/flutter
+ b712a172f...2d2a1ffec stable -> origin/stable (forced update)
+ a314da37b...7c2b25856 Hixie-patch-1 -> origin/Hixie-patch-1 (forced update)
+ b712a172f...2d2a1ffec beta -> origin/beta (forced update)
+ 2fefa8c73...ce45c2d3e dev -> origin/dev
* [new branch] generated_explicit_type -> origin/generated_explicit_type
* [new branch] keyonghan-deviceLabReadme -> origin/keyonghan-deviceLabReadme
+ 2ad5376a0...cd84ceaf5 master -> origin/master
* [new branch] potato620-patch-1 -> origin/potato620-patch-1
* [new branch] refactor -> origin/refactor
* [new branch] revert-37962-show-search-app-bar-theme -> origin/revert-37962-show-search-app-bar-theme
* [new branch] revert-38861-use_frame_timings -> origin/revert-38861-use_frame_timings
* [new branch] revert-38922-text-docs -> origin/revert-38922-text-docs
+ b712a172f...20e59316b v1.7.8-hotfixes -> origin/v1.7.8-hotfixes
```

Figure 1: Upgrading Flutter to the latest version

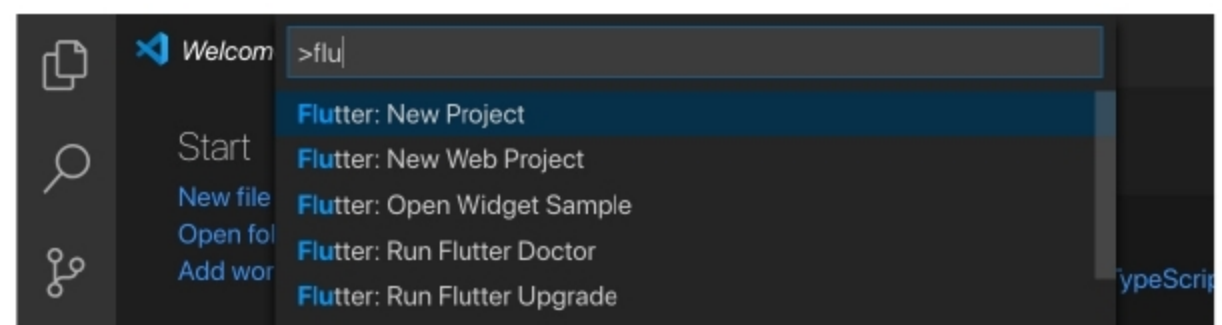


Figure 2: Starting a new Flutter Web project in VSC

Now use the following command to run the website, on localhost, with the IP address `127.0.0.1`

```
flutter packages pub global run webdev serve
```

Open any browser and type, `http://127.0.0.1:8080/`

There is a Web folder inside the project directory which contains an `index.html` file. The `dart` file is compiled into a JavaScript file and is included in the HTML file using the following code: